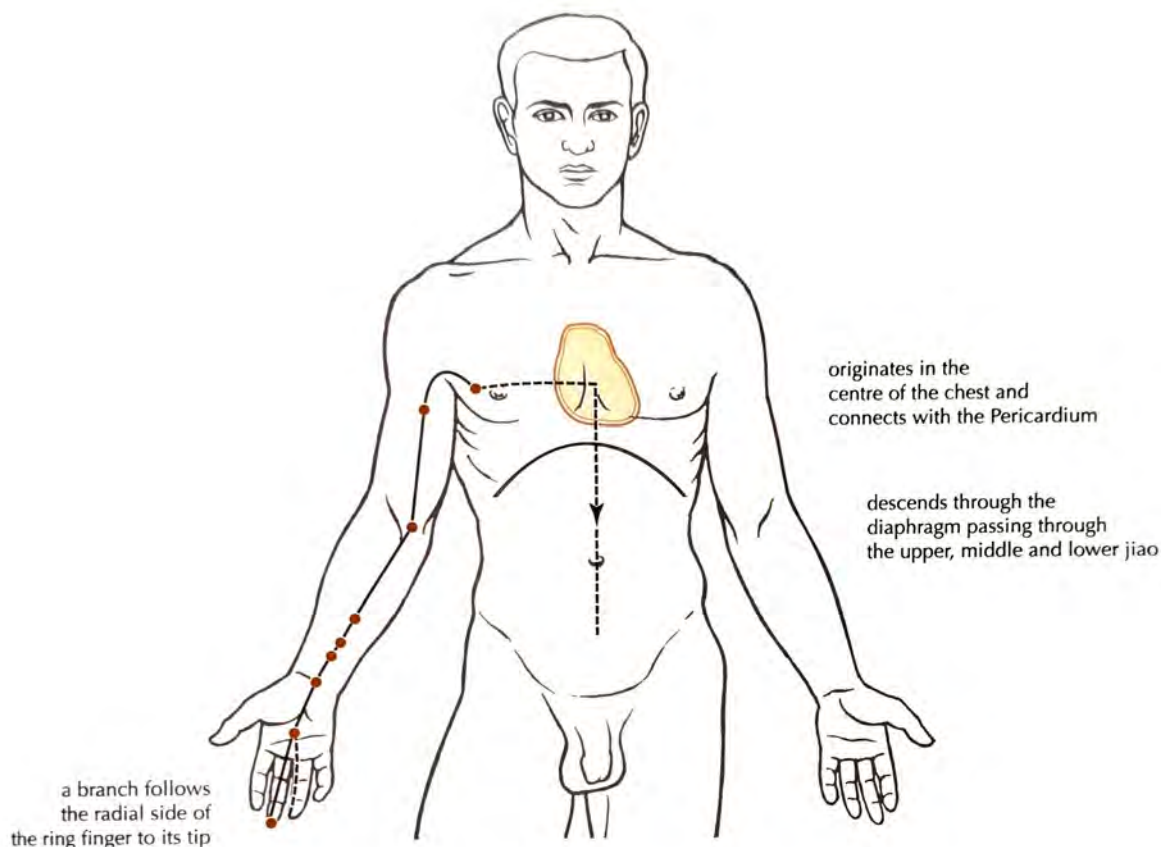


手厥陰心包經

THE PERICARDIUM
CHANNEL
OF HAND JUEYIN

THE PERICARDIUM CHANNEL OF HAND JUEYIN



The Pericardium primary channel

THE PERICARDIUM PRIMARY CHANNEL

- originates in the centre of the chest, connects with the Pericardium, and descends through the diaphragm to the abdomen, passing through the upper, middle and lower jiao.

One branch

- runs from inside the chest to emerge in the costal region 3 cun inferior to the anterior axillary fold (near Tianchi P-1),
- arches over the axilla, and follows along the antero-medial aspect of the upper arm, between the Lung and Heart channels to the cubital fossa of the elbow at Quze P-3,
- descends the forearm between the tendons of the

palmaris longus and flexor carpi radialis muscles to reach the palm at Laogong P-8,

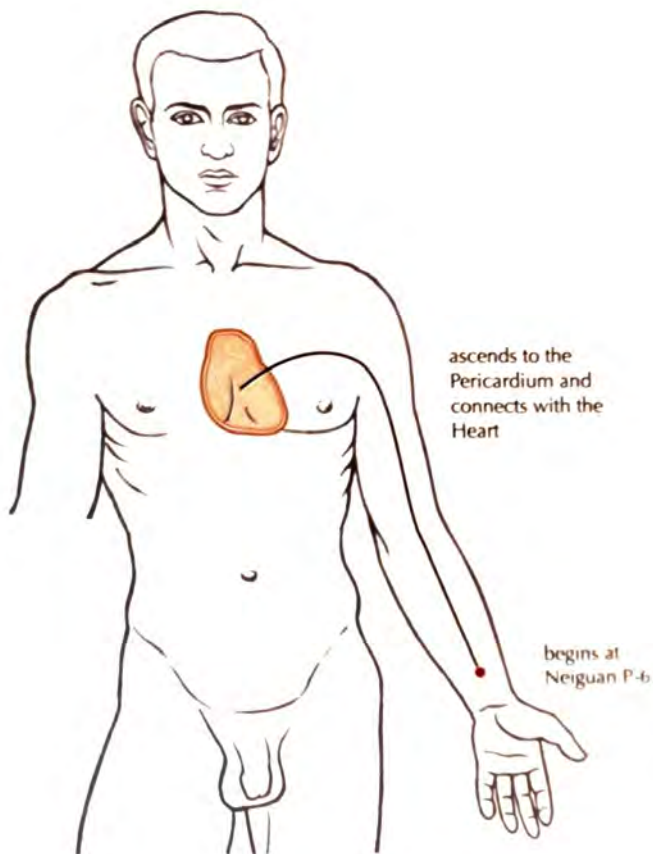
- travels from the palm along the middle finger to terminate at its tip at Zhongchong P-9.

Another branch

- arises from the palm at Laogong P-8 and follows the radial aspect of the ring finger to its tip .

The Pericardium primary channel connects with the following zangfu: Sanjiao.

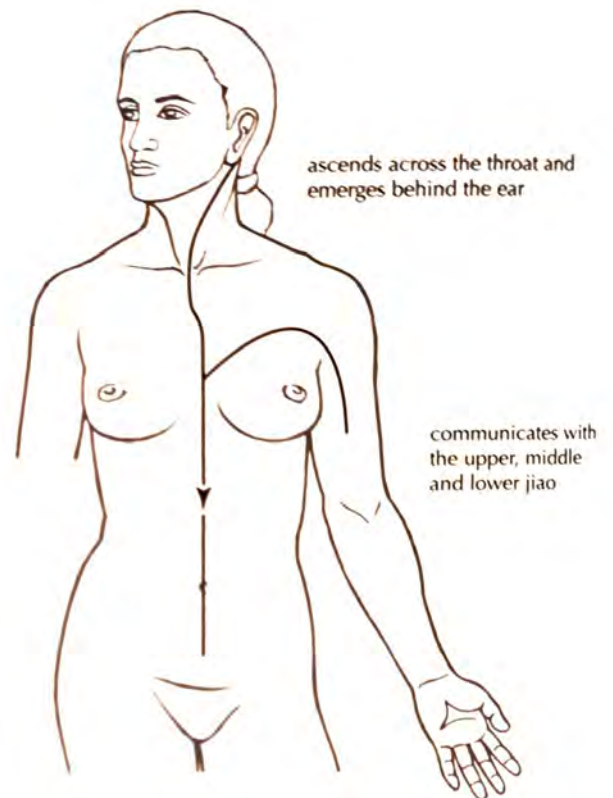
The Pericardium primary channel meets with other channels at the following points: Tianchi P-1



The Pericardium luo-connecting channel

THE PERICARDIUM LUO-CONNECTING CHANNEL

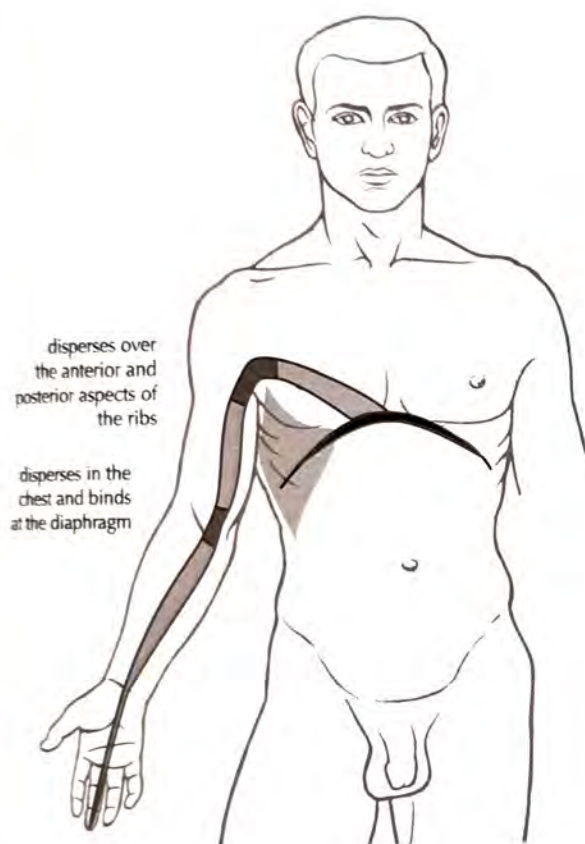
- begins at Neiguan P-6 on the anterior of the forearm,
- ascends along with the Pericardium primary channel to the Pericardium and then connects with the Heart.



The Pericardium divergent channel

THE PERICARDIUM DIVERGENT CHANNEL

- separates from the primary channel on the arm, at the level of a point below the axilla and 3 cun inferior to Yuanye GB-22,
- enters the chest and communicates with the three jiao,
- a branch ascends across the throat and emerges behind the ear to converge with the Sanjiao channel.



The Pericardium sinew channel

THE PERICARDIUM SINEW CHANNEL

- originates at the tip of the middle finger and runs together with the Lung sinew channel to bind at the medial side of the elbow,
- follows the antero-medial side of the upper arm to below the axilla where it binds before descending to disperse over the anterior and posterior aspects of the ribs,
- a branch enters the chest below the axilla, dispersing in the chest and binding at the diaphragm.

Pathological symptoms of the Pericardium sinew channel
Strained and cramping sensation along the course of the channel, pain of the chest with urgent breathing and an 'inverted cup sensation' below the lower right ribs.

DISCUSSION

The Pericardium channel of hand jueyin originates in the chest and descends through the diaphragm to the middle and lower jiao. It is interiorly-exteriorly coupled with the Sanjiao channel, and with the Liver channel of foot jueyin according to six channel theory. The Pericardium-Sanjiao relationship is strengthened by the fact that:

- a branch of the Pericardium channel separates from Laogong P-8 in the palm of the hand and connects with Guanchong SJ-1 on the ring finger.
- the Pericardium divergent channel connects with the Sanjiao channel behind the ear.
- as far as the Pericardium luo-connecting channel is concerned, in the *Spiritual Pivot* at least there is no reference to it connecting with the Sanjiao channel.

In addition, it is important to note that:

- from Neiguan P-6, the luo-connecting channel travels to the Heart, strengthening the Pericardium-Heart relationship.
- the Pericardium primary channel originates in the chest, its divergent channel enters the chest, and its sinew channel disperses in the chest.
- the primary channel descends through the diaphragm and the sinew channel binds at the diaphragm.
- both the primary and divergent channels connect with the upper, middle and lower jiao.
- the primary channel arches over the axilla and the sinew channel travels inferior to the axilla.
- the sinew channel disperses over the anterior and posterior ribs.

The Pericardium (xin bao / Heart wrapping) is described in Chinese medicine as a membrane surrounding the Heart, and its primary function is to protect the Heart (the Emperor) from attack by exterior pathogenic factors. In the *Yellow Emperor's Inner Classic*, the Pericardium was not accorded independent status as one of the zangfu, and this has been reflected in the Chinese medical tradition ever since in discussion of the 'five zang and six fu'. Although not considered a discrete zang, but rather an appendage of the Heart, the Pericardium channel paradoxically was originally considered the primary channel to treat Heart disorders. Thus in the *Spiritual Pivot*¹ the Yellow Emperor asks Qi Bo "Why does the hand shaoyin channel alone have no shu points"? Qi Bo replies "The shaoyin is the Heart vessel. The Heart is the great master of the five zang and six fu and is the abode of the essence-spirit. It stores so firmly that no pathogen can come to reside. If it does, then the Heart will be injured and the spirit will depart. If the spirit departs there is death. It is for this reason that the pathogens destined to attack the Heart will attack

the Pericardium. The Pericardium is the channel that is controlled by the Heart. Therefore the Heart alone has no shu points". In Chapter 2 of the *Spiritual Pivot Qi Bo* describes the Heart channel (rather than the Pericardium channel) as originating at Zhongchong P-9 and travelling to Laogong P-8, Daling P-7 etc. as far as Quze P-3. The *Spiritual Pivot* elsewhere, however, does discuss points of the Heart channel, for example Shenmen HE-7 for Heart disorders, reflecting some of the contradictions inherent in a text written by different authors at different times. It was not until the *Systematic Classic of Acupuncture and Moxibustion*, written in the third century, that the shu points of the Heart channel were first discussed.

In the theory of differentiation of patterns according to the zangfu, the Pericardium has no patterns of disharmony of its own. The only discussion of Pericardium disorders per se follows on from its function as the wrapping or protector of the Heart, and the disturbance of consciousness manifesting as mental confusion and even coma that occurs during the course of febrile diseases is ascribed to the Pericardium rather than to the Heart.

The Pericardium channel pathways, as well as the status of the Pericardium as the protector of the Heart, help explain most of the actions and indications of the points of the Pericardium channel. These can be summarised as:

- treating disorders of the Heart zang such as pain, palpitations, irregular Heart rhythm etc.
- treating disorders of the spirit.
- treating disorders of the chest in general, including disharmony of the Lung.
- treating disorders of the upper or middle jiao due to stagnation of the qi of the foot jueyin Liver channel with which the Pericardium channel is paired according to six channel theory.
- treating disorders of the middle jiao, especially the Stomach.
- treating disorders of the lateral costal region (the Pericardium sinew channel disperses over the anterior and posterior ribs).
- treating febrile diseases: the Pericardium belongs to fire, and takes the brunt of attack by exterior pathogens that might otherwise injure the Heart; the points of the Pericardium channel, therefore, are important in the treatment of febrile diseases, especially at the nutritive and blood levels and when there is disturbance of consciousness.
- treating swelling and pain of the axilla.

TIANCHÍ P-1

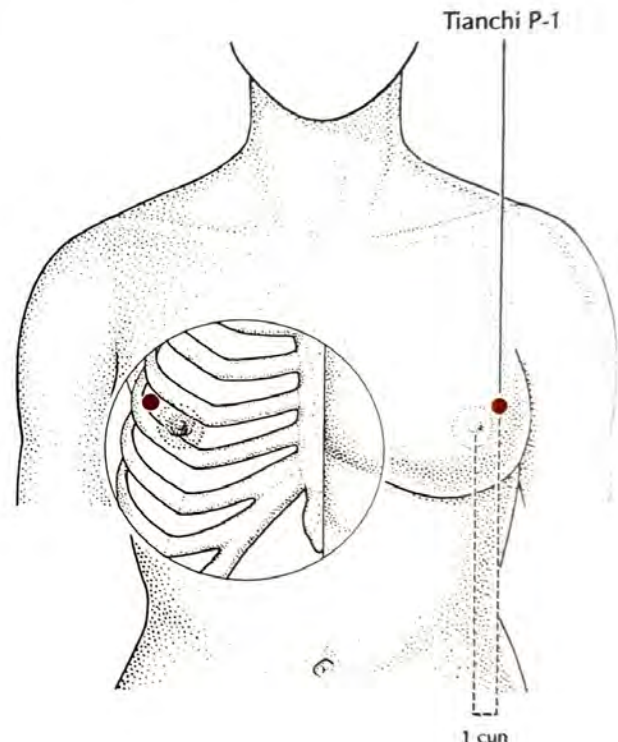
Heavenly Pool

天池

Meeting point of the Pericardium, Gall Bladder, Liver and Sanjiao channels
Point of the Window of Heaven

LOCATION

1 cun lateral and slightly superior to the nipple, in the 4th intercostal space.



LOCATION NOTE

The level of the fourth intercostal space at this point is more or less the same as that of the fourth intercostal space at its junction with the sternum.

NEEDLING

Transverse-oblique insertion posteriorly along the intercostal space, 0.5 to 1 cun.

Caution: deep needling carries a substantial risk of causing a pneumothorax.

ACTIONS

Unbinds the chest, transforms phlegm and descends rebellion
Regulates qi and dissipates nodules
Benefits the breasts

INDICATIONS

- Cough with copious phlegm, rattling sound in the chest and throat, fullness of the chest, agitation of the chest and diaphragm, shortness of breath, uprising qi, pain of the lateral costal region.
- Swelling and pain of the axilla, scrofula of the neck, breast diseases, breast abscess, insufficient lactation.
- Headache, blurred vision, malaria, fever with absence of sweating, inability to raise the four limbs, pain of the arm.

COMMENTARY

Tianchi P-1 is one of ten points listed in Chapter 2 of the *Spiritual Pivot* that have come to be known as Window of Heaven points. With the exception of Tianchi P-1 and Tianfu LU-3, all are located in the neck region. In common with other points from this group, Tianchi P-1 is indicated for various manifestations of inversion qi (chaotic and rebellious qi), in this case affecting the Lung (uprising qi, cough etc.), head (headache), sense organs (blurred vision) and neck region (scrofula). For a fuller discussion of this point grouping see page 48.

Tianchi P-1 is almost exclusively indicated for excess patterns. Because of its location it is used for disorders of the chest and lateral costal region, especially those characterised by stagnant qi and phlegm. When qi and phlegm stagnate in the chest there is cough with copious sputum, fullness of the chest, agitation of the chest and diaphragm etc. When qi stagnates in the lateral costal region there is pain. When qi and phlegm stagnate in the channels (the Pericardium primary channel arches over the axilla and the sinew channel travels inferior to the axilla) there is axillary swelling and scrofula. Although not classically indicated for breast disorders, modern indications for Tianchi P-1 include breast abscess and insufficient lactation. Both these disorders may be due to stagnation of qi and consequent stagnant heat.

COMBINATIONS

- Swelling of the axilla: Tianchi P-1 and Weiyang BL-39 (*One Hundred Symptoms*).
- Swelling of the axilla: Tianchi P-1, Weiyang BL-39, Shenmai BL-62, Diwuhui GB-42, Yangfu GB-38 and Zulinqi GB-41 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Scrofula: Tianchi P-1, Shaohai HE-3, Zhangmen LIV-13, Zulinqi GB-41, Zhigou SJ-6, Yangfu GB-38, Jianjing GB-21 and Shousanli LI-10 (*Great Compendium*).
- Rebellious qi cough: Tianchi P-1, Tiantu REN-22, Shanzhong REN-17, Jiexi ST-41 and Jianzhongshu SI-15 (*Supplementing Life*).

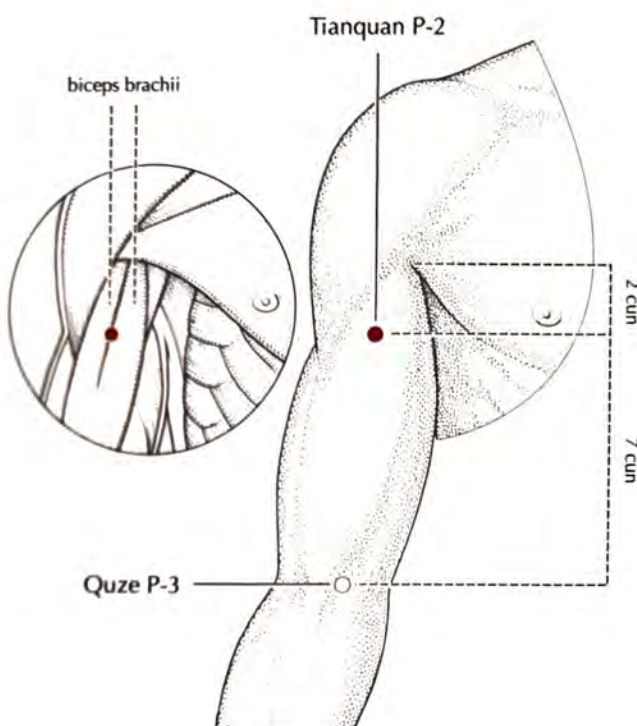
TIĀNQUÁN P-2

Heavenly Spring

天泉

LOCATION

On the anterior aspect of the arm, 2 cun below the anterior axillary fold, between the two heads of the biceps brachii muscle.



NEEDLING

Oblique insertion distally or proximally along the line of the channel, 1 to 1.5 cun.

ACTIONS

Unbinds the chest, invigorates blood and alleviates pain

INDICATIONS

- Heart pain, disorders of the Heart, pain of the chest, back, shoulder, shoulder blade and arm, fullness of the chest and lateral costal region, palpitations, cough, stone oedema.
- Aversion to wind and cold, blurred vision, pain of the medial aspect of the upper arm.

COMBINATIONS

- Heart pain radiating to the shoulder and arm: Tianquan P-2, Ximen P-4, Neiguan P-6 and Shanzhong REN-17.

QŪZÉ P-3

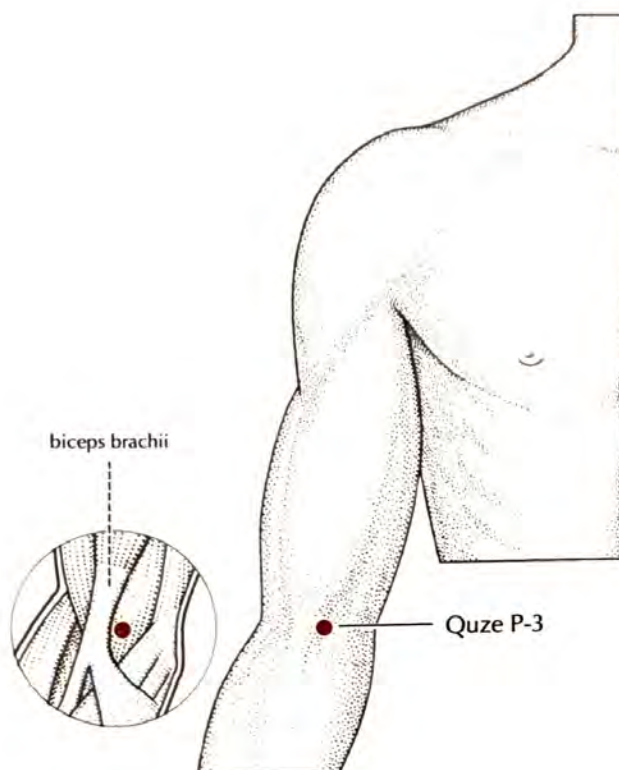
Marsh at the Crook

He-Sea and Water point of the
Pericardium channel

曲
澤

LOCATION

On the transverse cubital crease, in the depression immediately to the ulnar side of the aponeurosis of the biceps brachii muscle.

**LOCATION NOTE**

This point should be located and needled with the elbow slightly bent.

NEEDLING

Perpendicular insertion 0.5 to 1 cun, or prick to bleed.

Caution: the brachial artery and veins lie deeply, just medial to this point.

ACTIONS

Clears heat from the qi, nutritive and blood levels

Harmonises the Stomach and intestines and stops vomiting

Activates the channel and alleviates pain

INDICATIONS

- Febrile disease, agitation and restlessness, agitation with thirst, dry mouth, dry tongue with pain of the lateral costal region, coughing blood, vomiting blood, summer-heat stroke.
- Vomiting, diarrhoea, dysenteric disorder, sudden turmoil disorder.
- Heart pain, palpitations, pounding sensation below the Heart, propensity to fright, counterflow qi, dyspnoea and cough, wind rash.
- Tremor of the head, tremor of the hand and arm, pain and contraction of the elbow and arm, paralysis of the upper limb.

COMMENTARY

In the 3rd century CE, the *Treatise on Injury by Cold* by Zhang Zhong-jing classified fevers according to their progression through the six channels (taiyang, yangming, shaoyang, taiyin, shaoyin and jueyin). This theory, according to which pathogenic cold attacked and penetrated the body via the skin, dominated Chinese medicine until the early 17th century when the 'wen bing' or 'warm disease' theory was developed (predominantly by Wu You-he, Ye Tian-shi and Wu Ju-tong). The warm disease school placed the emphasis on febrile diseases due to injury by heat which penetrates the body via the nose and mouth, and classified fevers according to four levels of depth: the defensive level (wei), the qi level (qi), the nutritive level (ying) and the blood level (xue). The defensive and qi levels correspond broadly to the taiyang and yangming stages respectively of the *Treatise on Injury by Cold*. When pathogenic heat penetrates further to the deeper levels of the body, it first enters the nutritive level, scorching the body fluids and the yin and disturbing the Pericardium and spirit, and then enters the blood level, giving rise to reckless bleeding. Quze P-3, the water point of the Pericardium fire channel, clears heat and may be needled or bled for heat at the qi level giving rise to high fever, agitation, thirst etc., or for heat which has reached the nutritive and blood levels giving rise to agitation and restlessness, dry mouth and haemorrhage from the Lung and Stomach.

According to the *Classic of Difficulties*² the he-sea points treat 'counterflow qi and diarrhoea', whilst the *Spiritual Pivot*³ says "in disorders of the Stomach and in disorders resulting from irregular eating and drinking, select the he-sea point". These theories are clearly illustrated by Quze P-3 which has the functions of harmonising the Stomach and intestines and stopping vomiting and diarrhoea, especially when these are acute and due to pathogenic heat. It is also worth noting that the interior pathway of the Pericardium channel descends through the diaphragm to the lower

abdomen, connecting the upper, middle and lower jiao, which helps to explain the powerful action of this point on these disorders. The dual action of Quze P-3 in harmonising the Stomach and intestines and clearing pathogenic heat, makes it particularly suitable for treating diseases due to summer-heat (heatstroke or sunstroke) characterised by fever, sweating, vomiting and diarrhoea.

According to the *Spiritual Pivot*⁴ "jueyin channel is abundant in blood and limited in qi ... [it is thus suitable to] prick to bleed jueyin and drain blood ...". This theory explains the effect of bleeding Quze P-3 on reducing heat in the blood in cases of febrile haemorrhage. Interestingly, one of the two other channels "abundant in blood and limited in qi" according to this passage in the *Spiritual Pivot* is the taiyang channel, and this may help to explain certain similarities between Quze P-3 (the he-sea point of the Pericardium jueyin channel located at the flexure of the elbow) and Weizhong BL-40 (the he-sea point of the Bladder taiyang channel located at the flexure of the knee). Both points may be pricked to bleed to clear heat from the blood level, and are used in the treatment of summer-heat stroke and sudden turmoil disorder with heat of the four limbs, ceaseless thirst, vomiting and diarrhoea.

Finally, Quze P-3 is also widely used for disorders of the Pericardium channel such as pain of the elbow, arm and hand. It is indicated for tremor of the head, and like its close neighbour Shaohai HE-3, for tremor of the hand and arm.

COMBINATIONS

- Vomiting blood: Quze P-3, Shenmen HE-7 and Yuji LU-10 (*Great Compendium*).
- Spitting blood: Quze P-3, Kongzui LU-6 and Feishu BL-13 (*Supplementing Life*).
- Pounding sensation below the Heart and propensity to fright: Quze P-3 and Daling P-7 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Pain of the Heart and chest: Quze P-3, Neiguan P-6 and Daling P-7 (*Great Compendium*).
- Heart pain: Quze P-3, Ximen P-4 and Daling P-7 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Dry mouth: Quze P-3 and Zhangmen LIV-13 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Thirst from blood deficiency: Quze P-3 and Shaoshang LU-11 (*One Hundred Symptoms*).
- Absence of sweating: Quze P-3, Fuli KID-7, Yuji LU-10, Shaoze SI-1, Shangxing DU-23, Ququan LIV-8, Kunlun BL-60, Xiashi GB-43 and Zuqiaoyin GB-44 (*Great Compendium*).

XIMEN P-4

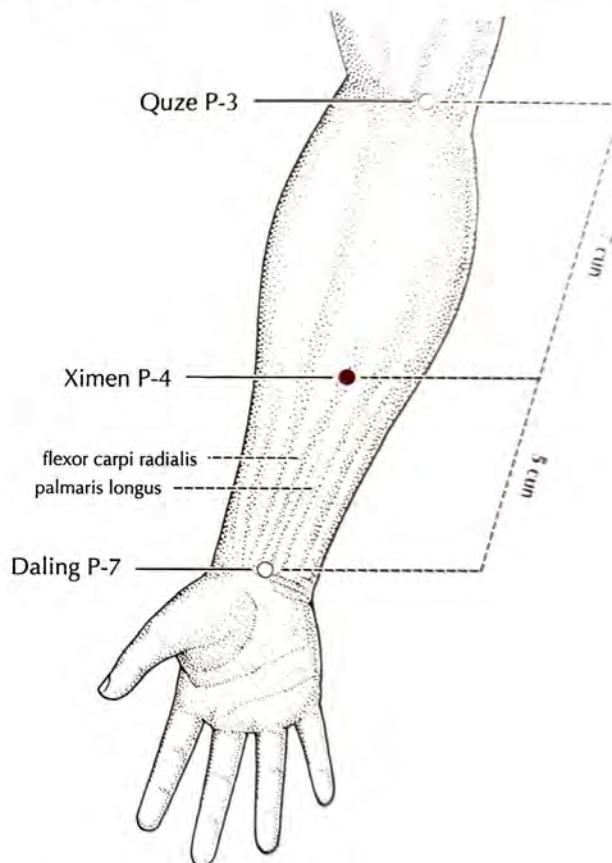
Xi-Cleft Gate

郄門

Xi-Cleft point of the Pericardium channel

LOCATION

On the flexor aspect of the forearm, 5 cun proximal to Daling P-7, on the line connecting Daling P-7 and Quze P-3, between the tendons of palmaris longus and flexor carpi radialis.



LOCATION NOTE

i. In the absence of the tendon of palmaris longus, locate this point on the ulnar side of the tendon of flexor carpi radialis; ii. Divide the distance between the cubital crease and Daling P-7 into half and locate this point 1 cun distal to this midpoint.

NEEDLING

Perpendicular insertion, 0.5 to 1 cun or oblique proximal insertion 1 to 1.5 cun.

ACTIONS

Invigorates blood and dispels stasis
Cools blood and stops bleeding
Calms the spirit
Moderates acute conditions

INDICATIONS

- Chest pain, Heart pain, Heart pain with vomiting, vomiting blood, coughing blood, nosebleed, five palms agitated and hot.
- Agitation, insomnia, melancholy, fear and fright of people, insufficiency of spirit qi, epilepsy.
- Chronic malaria, chronic haemorrhoids.

COMMENTARY

Ximen P-4 is the xi-cleft point of the Pericardium channel. The xi-cleft points are where the qi and blood, which flow relatively superficially along the channels from the jing-well points, gather and plunge more deeply. The xi-cleft points in general are indicated in the treatment of acute conditions and pain, whilst the xi-cleft points of the yin channels have an additional action of treating disorders of blood. Ximen P-4 is an important point to treat both acute stasis of blood and heat in the blood.

Through its dual actions of invigorating blood and moderating acute conditions, Ximen P-4 is a primary point for treating stagnation of blood in the chest and Heart, giving rise to acute pain which may radiate to the neck, back or left arm, or be accompanied by vomiting. Its important role in the treatment of Heart pain was both emphasised in the classics and is borne out by modern clinical practice and research.

By virtue of its ability to clear heat from the blood and stop bleeding, Ximen P-4 is indicated for hot reckless bleeding in the upper jiao giving rise to nosebleed, and vomiting or coughing of blood.

The second principal group of indications for Ximen P-4 includes a variety of mental and emotional disorders such as agitation of the Heart, insomnia, melancholy, and fear and fright of people. The relationship between Ximen P-4 and emotional disorders is expressed through its effect on the blood and the Heart qi. The Heart rules the blood and houses the spirit, and there is therefore a reciprocal relationship between blood and disturbance of the spirit. On the one hand when the blood is stagnant and does not flow freely, essential nourishment will not reach the Heart and the Heart's function of housing the spirit may be disrupted. On the other hand, emotional disturbance may lead to stagnation of blood. The *Spiritual Pivot*⁵ states " ... Internally a person may be injured by worry and anger; when this occurs the qi will rebel upwards; when the qi rebels thus the six shu [points of the six channels] will not flow, the warm qi will not circulate and internally the congealed blood will coagulate and not scatter ...". By resolving stasis of blood Ximen P-4 is able both to treat emotional disharmony and to resolve the Heart blood stasis that results from it.

Blood stasis in the Heart most commonly occurs as a

result of deficiency of Heart qi and yang. These patterns frequently give rise to feelings of fear, melancholy and a diminished spirit, typically seen in patients after a myocardial infarct or cardiac surgery (the shock of which may further injure the Heart qi). Ximen P-4 is able to regulate the Heart qi, as well as the blood, and is classically indicated for insufficiency of the spirit qi.

Finally there may be symptoms of mental and emotional agitation, as well as haemorrhage, when heat enters the nutritive or blood levels during febrile disease and rises to disturb the spirit. Thus the *Treatise on Epidemic Warm Febrile Disease* stated "When the nutritive system is invaded by heat, the blood is consumed, the spirit is disturbed and there is insomnia". Ximen P-4 is able to calm the spirit in such cases by clearing heat from the nutritive and blood levels.

COMBINATIONS

- Heart pain: Ximen P-4, Quze P-3 and Daling P-7 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Heart pain with retching, agitation and fullness: Ximen P-4 and Jiquan HE-1 (*Supplementing Life*).
- Coughing blood: Ximen P-4 and Daling P-7 (*Systematic Classic*).
- Fright and fear of people, spirit qi insufficient: Ximen P-4 and Dazhong KID-4 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Pain of the chest and lateral costal region: Ximen P-4, Dabao SP-21, Sanyangluo SJ-8, Yangfu GB-38 and Zulinqi GB-41.

JIĀNSHǐ P-5

Intermediate Messenger

Jing-River and Metal point of the Pericardium channel

間使

LOCATION

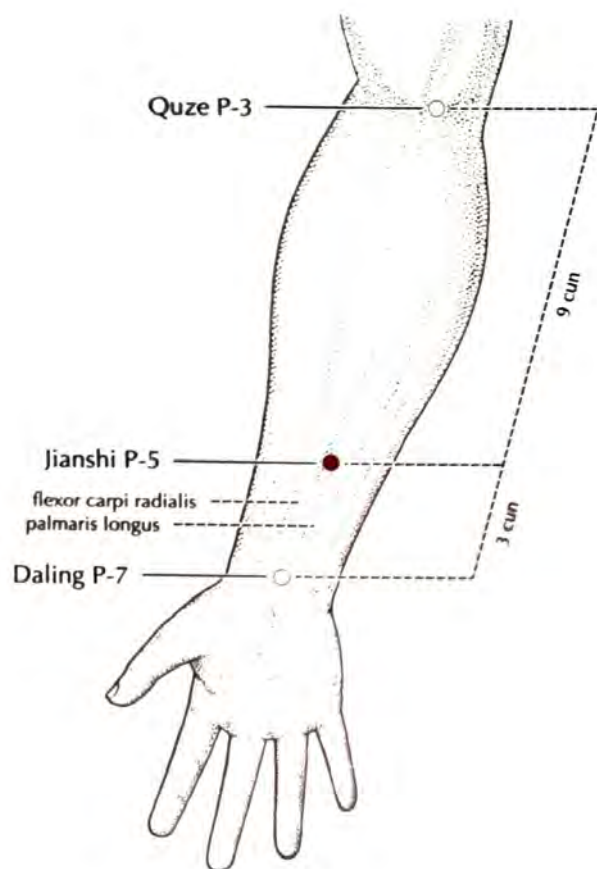
On the flexor aspect of the forearm, 3 cun proximal to Daling P-7, between the tendons of palmaris longus and flexor carpi radialis.

LOCATION NOTE

- In the absence of the tendon of palmaris longus, locate this point on the ulnar side of the tendon of flexor carpi radialis;
- Divide the distance between the cubital crease and Daling P-7 into quarters and locate this point at the junction of the proximal three quarters and the distal quarter.

NEEDLING

Perpendicular insertion, 0.5 to 1 cun or oblique proximal insertion 1 to 1.5 cun.



ACTIONS

Transforms phlegm
 Settles and calms the spirit
 Descends rebellious qi and regulates the Stomach
 Regulates menstruation

INDICATIONS

- Sudden Heart pain, palpitations, oppression of the chest, apprehension, propensity to fright, epilepsy, mania, agitation and restlessness, poor memory, loss of voice, halting speech, sudden mania, manic raving as if seeing ghosts, sudden fright disorder in children, ghost evil.
- Plumstone qi (globus hystericus), goitre, scrofula of the neck, drooling following windstroke, obstruction of qi following windstroke leading to impaired breathing.
- Epigastric pain, vomiting, retching, nausea, vomiting and spitting of blood, vomiting of foam, sudden turmoil disorder, abdominal pain, clonic spasm.
- Aversion to wind and cold, febrile disease, malaria, red face and yellow eyes.
- Irregular menstruation, dysmenorrhoea, diseases of menstruation, clotted menstrual flow, leucorrhoea, retention of lochia, painful urinary dysfunction, urethral pain.

- Swelling of the axilla, pain of the inner aspect of the elbow and arm, heat of the palms, weakness of the wrist.

COMMENTARY

The key action of Jianshi P-5 is to transform phlegm in the upper jiao, and predominantly in the Heart. Together with Fenglong ST-40 it is one of the two main acupuncture points to treat phlegm disorders. Phlegm obstructing the Heart may arise in one of the following ways: i. excess of any of the seven emotions results in stagnation of qi which hinders the smooth circulation of body fluids, and by transforming into fire, further condenses the stagnant body fluids to form phlegm; ii. stagnation of Liver qi impairs the Spleen's function of transforming and transporting fluids which form phlegm and rise with stagnant qi to disturb the Heart; iii. high fever condenses the body fluids into phlegm, in which case Chinese medicine convention ascribes the disorder to the Pericardium; iv. fright generates phlegm, a concept expounded by Gong Ju-zhong in *A Spot of Snow on a Red Hot Stove*⁶ "Phlegm is produced by fright. The spirit leaves its residence, and when the residence is empty, the fluids will form phlegm".

When phlegm or phlegm-fire obstruct and agitate the portals of the Heart, the spirit will be disturbed to varying degrees. There may be milder symptoms such as agitation, apprehension, propensity to fright, poor memory, restlessness and being easily startled, or more severe symptoms such as mania, manic raving, epilepsy and what was known as 'ghost evil', a disorder probably attributed to demonic possession. Jianshi P-5 also treats phlegm manifestations such as drooling following windstroke, vomiting of foam, swelling of the axilla, goitre, scrofula, and plumstone qi (globus hystericus), a form of stagnation and obstruction by qi and phlegm characterised by a sensation of throat blockage which worsens or ameliorates according to fluctuations in the emotional state. The importance of Jianshi P-5 in the treatment of mania disorder and epilepsy is reflected by the fact that Sun Si-miao's *Supplement to the Thousand Ducat Formulas* suggested that this point was Guilu (one of the thirteen ghost points), rather than Shenmai BL-62 which was said to correspond to Guilu in the *Thousand Ducat Formulas*.

The Pericardium channel and its interiorly-exteriorly related Sanjiao channel both connect with the upper, middle and lower jiao. The action of Jianshi P-5, therefore, is not confined to the upper jiao. In the middle jiao, like Neiguan P-6, it regulates the function of the Stomach and promotes its descending function, being indicated when Stomach qi stagnates giving rise to pain, and when Stomach qi rebels upwards giving rise to vomiting and nausea. Its ability to regulate the Stomach is considered

less powerful than that of Neiguan P-6, but it may be used when nausea and vomiting is due to retention of phlegm in the middle jiao. Jianshi P-5 is also indicated for sudden turmoil disorder characterised by acute vomiting and diarrhoea.

According to the *Essential Questions*⁷ "The bao mai (uterine channel) pertains to the Heart and is connected with the uterus". Jianshi P-5 is one of the few points of either the Heart or Pericardium channels that has an action on gynaecological disorders, being indicated for irregular menstruation, dysmenorrhoea, clotted menstrual flow, retention of the lochia and leucorrhoea. Its action on the lower jiao also extends to the treatment of painful urinary dysfunction and urethral pain.

Finally, according to the *Spiritual Pivot*⁸ the jing-river points are indicated for 'changes in the patient's voice' and Jianshi P-5 is indicated for halting speech and loss of voice.

COMBINATIONS

- Sudden mania: Jianshi P-5, Hegu L.I.-4 and Houxi SI-3 (*Great Compendium*).
- Mania: Jianshi P-5, Baihui DU-20, Fuliu KID-7, Yingu KID-10 and Zusanli ST-36 (*Illustrated Supplement*).
- Epilepsy: Jianshi P-5 and Renzhong DU-26 (*Ode of Spiritual Brightness*).
- Excessive fright: Jianshi P-5, Yinxi HE-6, Erjian L.I.-2 and Lidui ST-45 (*Supplementing Life*).
- Obstruction of the throat: Jianshi P-5 and Sanjian L.I.-3 (*Great Compendium*).
- Swelling of the face and abdomen: Jianshi P-5, Zhongfu LU-1 and Hegu L.I.-4 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Red and white leucorrhoea: Jianshi P-5, Baihuanshu BL-30, Daimai GB-26, Guanyuan REN-4, Qihai REN-6 and Sanyinjiao SP-6 (*Great Compendium*).
- The five types of malaria with severe chills and even more severe fever: Jianshi P-5 and Dazhu BL-11 (*Song More Precious Than Jade*).
- Contraction of the elbow: Jianshi P-5, Xiaohai SI-8, Chize LU-5, Jianyu L.I.-15, Daling P-7, Houxi SI-3 and Yuji LU-10 (*Great Compendium*).

NÈIGUĀN P-6

Inner Pass

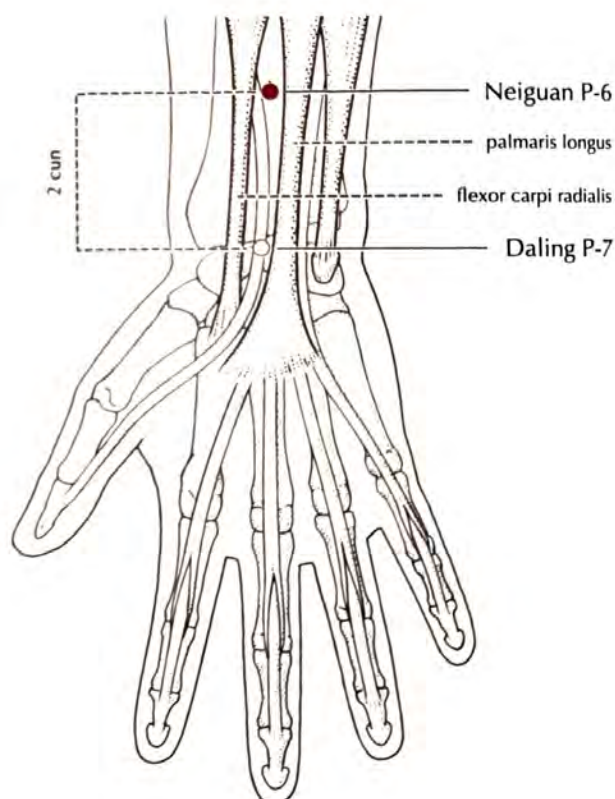
Luo-Connecting point of the Pericardium channel
Confluent point of the Yin Linking vessel

LOCATION

On the flexor aspect of the forearm, 2 cun proximal to Daling P-7, between the tendons of palmaris longus and flexor carpi radialis.

LOCATION NOTE

In the absence of the tendon of palmaris longus, locate this point on the ulnar side of the tendon of flexor carpi radialis.



NEEDLING

i. Perpendicular insertion 0.5 to 1 cun, or joined to Waiguan SJ-5; ii. Oblique proximal insertion 1 to 1.5 cun for diseases of the chest; iii. Oblique distal insertion 1 to 1.5 cun for numbness of the fingers.

Caution: the median nerve lies directly under this point and needling commonly induces a significant electric sensation. This is an acceptable manifestation of deqi (arrival of qi), but once elicited, further manipulation is inappropriate and may damage the nerve.

內關

ACTIONS

Unbinds the chest and regulates qi
 Regulates the Heart and calms the spirit
 Harmonises the Stomach and alleviates nausea and vomiting
 Clears heat
 Opens the Yin Linking vessel

INDICATIONS

- Heart pain, sudden Heart pain, stuffiness of the chest with agitation of the Heart, palpitations, fright palpitations, pounding sensation of the Heart, disorders of Heart rate and rhythm, pain of the lateral costal region and Heart in women, pain of the lateral costal region, cough, asthma.
- Insomnia, the five types of epilepsy, mania, poor memory, apprehension, fear and fright, sadness, loss of memory following windstroke, inability to speak after windstroke, windstroke, hypertension.
- Nausea, vomiting, hiccup, deficiency and cold of the Spleen and Stomach with incessant vomiting, Spleen and Stomach qi deficiency with distention and fullness, disharmony of the Spleen and Stomach, epigastric pain, stabbing epigastric pain, low-grade abdominal pain, food (ji) masses, blood (jia) masses, focal distention, borborygmus, diarrhoea, blood in the stools, prolapse of the rectum.
- Febrile disease, fever with absence of sweating, headache, stiffness and pain of the head and neck, jaundice, yellow eyes, red eyes, red face with hot skin, malaria, cracked and bleeding tongue, dizziness, post-partum dizziness, irregular menstruation, painful urinary dysfunction.
- Pain and contraction of the elbow and upper arm, swelling of the axilla, stiffness and pain of the head and neck.

COMMENTARY

The Pericardium primary channel originates in the chest, its divergent channel enters the chest, its sinew channel disperses in the chest and over the anterior and posterior ribs and its luo-connecting channel connects with the Heart. Neiguan P-6, a point of the Pericardium channel, is also the confluent point of the Yin Linking vessel which ascends through the chest. According to the *Classic of Difficulties* "When the Yin Linking vessel is diseased, Heart pain will result". In the *Ode of the Obstructed River* the use of Neiguan P-6 is referred to as one of 'the eight therapeutic methods'. In this description of the application of the eight confluent points of the extraordinary vessels to affect specific symptoms and areas of the body, Neiguan P-6 is indicated for disorders of the chest. The *Investigation*

into *Points Along the Channels* by the Ming dynasty author Yan Zhen-shi says "Neiguan P-6 treats all kinds of pain of the zangfu, chest and lateral costal region". Furthermore, Neiguan P-6 was included among the 'six command points' (a grouping derived by later commentators from Gao Wu's 'four command points') for its pre-eminent effect on diseases of the chest and lateral costal region. Neiguan P-6, therefore, has long been considered the single most important distal point for disorders of the chest and it is one of the primary points in acupuncture analgesia for chest surgery. Its range of actions extends not only to the Heart, but also to the Lung.

Pain and stuffiness of the Heart and chest may result from various aetiologies including i. Heart qi and yang deficiency, ii. accumulation of cold, iii. accumulation of phlegm, iv. blood stasis, v. constrained Liver qi, vi. traumatic injury. Whatever the pattern, Neiguan P-6 forms an essential part of any point combination. In the treatment of angina pectoris, however, certain doctors emphasise the use of Ximen P-4 (the xi-cleft point of the Pericardium channel) during acute attacks and Neiguan P-6 during remission. Neiguan P-6 is also effective to treat other disorders of the chest such as asthma and cough, as well as pain in the lateral costal region and hypochondrium. These last two symptoms reflect not only the pathway of the Pericardium sinew channel, but also the relationship of Neiguan P-6 to stagnation of Liver qi, explained by the paired relationship of the Pericardium and Liver jueyin channels. Neiguan P-6, therefore, is especially effective in treating stagnation of Liver qi anywhere in the upper and middle jiao.

The Pericardium is the 'wrapping' of the Heart which stores the spirit, and the Pericardium luo-connecting channel links Neiguan P-6 directly with the Heart. The action of Neiguan P-6 on regulating the Heart zang and calming the spirit emphasises its dual effect on both the physical and emotional aspects of the Heart. It is an important point in the treatment of palpitations, pounding of the Heart and disorders of Heart rhythm, and is also one of the main acupuncture points for regulating and calming the spirit and treating a wide range of emotional disorders whatever the underlying pattern. It is therefore indicated for insomnia, epilepsy, mania, poor memory, loss of memory following windstroke, fright, sadness, fear and apprehension.

The *Investigation into Points Along the Channels*, echoing many other classical texts, states that Neiguan P-6 is indicated "for disharmony of the Stomach and Spleen". The Pericardium primary and divergent channels both descend through the diaphragm to connect with the middle and lower jiao, and this explains the powerful effect of Neiguan P-6 on the function of the middle jiao. Neiguan

P-6 is the pre-eminent point to treat nausea and vomiting due to any aetiology, including vomiting of pregnancy and the side-effects of chemotherapy and radiotherapy. Its considerable effect in the treatment of such side-effects has rendered it the subject of more research in recent years than any other acupuncture point. Neiguan P-6 is further indicated for distention, fullness and pain of the epigastrium and abdomen, and is often combined with Gongsun SP-4, the confluent point of the Penetrating vessel, for this purpose.

The Pericardium channel belongs to fire, and like many other points of the channel Neiguan P-6 is indicated for a variety of manifestations of heat, including fevers, jaundice, red face with hot skin, painful urinary dysfunction, cracked and bleeding tongue etc.

Finally the *Great Compendium of Acupuncture and Moxibustion* gives specific indications for excess and deficiency of the luo-connecting points. In the case of Neiguan P-6 these are sudden Heart pain (excess); stiffness [and pain] of the head [and neck] (deficiency).

COMBINATIONS

- Oppression of the chest: Neiguan P-6 and Jianli REN-11 (*One Hundred Symptoms*).
- Pain of the Heart and chest: Neiguan P-6, Quze P-3 and Daling P-7 (*Great Compendium*).
- Fear and fright with Heart pain: Neiguan P-6, Shenmen HE-7, Shaochong HE-9 and Yanglingquan GB-34 (*Compilation*).
- Epilepsy: Neiguan P-6, Houxi SI-3, Shenmen HE-7, Xinshu BL-15 and Yinbai SP-1 (*Complete Collection*).
- Sudden turmoil disorder, headache, chest pain and dyspnoeic rales: Neiguan P-6, Renying ST-9, Guan-chong SJ-1, Sanyinjiao SP-6 and Zusanli ST-36 (*Compilation*).
- Difficult ingestion: Neiguan P-6, Yuji LU-10 and Zusanli ST-36 (*Great Compendium*).
- For quickly treating abdominal disease: Neiguan P-6 and Zhaohai KID-6 (*Ode of the Jade Dragon*).
- Abdominal pain: Neiguan P-6 and Gongsun SP-4 (*Ode of Xi-hong*).
- Abdominal pain: Neiguan P-6, Zusanli ST-36 and Zhongwan REN-12 (*Great Compendium*).
- Cracked and bleeding tongue: Neiguan P-6, Taichong LIV-3 and Yinjiao REN-7 (*Miscellaneous Diseases*).
- Red (bloody) dysenteric disorder: Neiguan P-6, Tianshu ST-25, Neiting ST-44, Yinbai SP-1, Qihai REN-6 and Zhaohai KID-6 (*Great Compendium*).
- Insufficient lactation due to Liver qi stagnation: Neiguan P-6, Rugen ST-18, Shanzhong REN-17, Shaoze SI-1 and Taichong LIV-3.

DÀLÍNG P-7

Great Mound

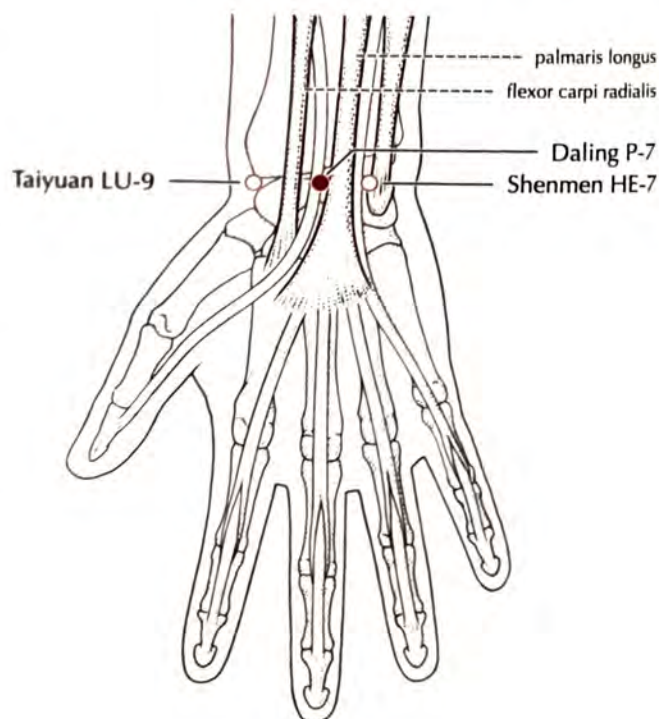
大陵

Shu-Stream, Yuan-Source and Earth point of the Pericardium channel

Sun Si-miao Ghost point

LOCATION

At the wrist joint, between the tendons of palmaris longus and flexor carpi radialis, level with Shenmen HE-7.



LOCATION NOTE

i. This point is commonly described as being at the wrist crease, which is variable. It is more reliably located level with Shenmen HE-7 which lies at the proximal border of the pisiform bone; ii. In the absence of the tendon of palmaris longus, locate this point on the ulnar side of the tendon of flexor carpi radialis.

NEEDLING

i. Perpendicular insertion 0.3 to 0.5 cun; ii. Oblique distal insertion along the carpal tunnel for carpal tunnel syndrome, 0.5 to 1 cun.

Caution: the median nerve lies directly under this point and needling commonly induces a significant electric sensation. This is an acceptable manifestation of deqi (arrival of qi), but once elicited, further manipulation is inappropriate and may damage the nerve.

ACTIONS

Clears heat from the Heart and calms the spirit

Harmonises the Stomach and intestines

Unbinds the chest

Clears the nutritive level and cools blood

INDICATIONS

- Heart pain, palpitations, pounding sensation of the Heart, insomnia, epilepsy, mania, manic raving, propensity to laugh (without ceasing), agitation, weeping with grief, sadness, fright and fear.
- Fullness of the chest, pain of the chest and lateral costal region, shortness of breath, much sighing, breast abscess, breast pain.
- Stomach pain, vomiting, vomiting blood, sudden turmoil disorder, intestinal abscess, foul breath.
- Fever with agitation and absence of sweating or ceaseless sweating, all wind-heat disorders with absence of sweating, heat in the body like fire.
- Red eyes, yellow eyes, jaundice, throat painful obstruction, dry throat, pain at the root of the tongue, eczema of the hand, wind rash, carbuncles and furuncles, splitting headache.
- Blood in the urine, difficult urination.
- Swelling of the axilla, contraction of the hand, pain and contraction of the elbow, wrist pain, heat in the palms.

COMMENTARY

Daling P-7 is the shu-stream, yuan-source and earth point of the Pericardium channel. The *Classic of Difficulties*¹⁰ states "in cases of deficiency reinforce the mother, in cases of excess reduce the child". The Pericardium channel belongs to fire, and as the earth (child) point of a fire (mother) channel Daling P-7 is able to reduce excess heat or fire from the Pericardium.

The Pericardium is known as the 'wrapping' of the Heart, and like most points of the Pericardium channel, Daling P-7 has a profound action on the Heart and spirit. So close was the relationship between the Pericardium and Heart perceived to be, that the *Spiritual Pivot* listed only five zang (omitting the Pericardium entirely as a discrete zang) whilst describing the Pericardium channel

as the channel pertaining to the Heart. Thus, for example, Daling P-7 rather than Shenmen HE-7 was listed as the yuan-source point of the Heart.

Daling P-7 is indicated in a wide variety of emotional disorders and is especially used whenever heat rises to disturb the spirit, whether due to: i. excess of any of the seven emotions transforming into fire; ii. stagnation of qi which both impairs the circulation of body fluids and transforms into fire resulting in phlegm-fire which harasses the Heart; iii. febrile heat collapsing into the Pericardium; iv. blazing heat arising from deficiency of yin. When the spirit is disrupted in this way it will give rise to such symptoms as palpitations, agitation, epilepsy, mania, manic raving, restlessness, insomnia, and anxiety. Under its alternative name of Guixin (Ghost Heart) Daling P-7 was included by Sun Si-miao among his 'thirteen ghost points' for the treatment of mania disorder and epilepsy.

The relationship of excessive laughter to Heart fire has long been recognised, for example Gong Tian-xian in *Achieving Longevity by Guarding the Source* stated "Ceaseless laughter is due to blazing of Heart fire". However as long ago as the *Yellow Emperor's Inner Classic* it was recognised that extravagant joy and deep sadness were equally manifestations of a disordered Heart spirit. Thus the *Spiritual Pivot*¹¹ says "The Heart rules the vessels, the vessels are the residence of the spirit, when Heart qi is deficient there is sadness, when excess there is ceaseless laughter", whilst the *Essential Questions*¹² states "The Heart stores the spirit ... when the spirit is in excess there is ceaseless laughter, when the spirit is insufficient there is sadness". The fact that Daling P-7 is indicated not only for ceaseless laughter but also for sadness and weeping with grief, reflects its application in both excess and deficiency disorders of the spirit.

If Heart fire transmits to its interiorly-exteriorly coupled Small Intestine channel, and from the Small Intestine (hand taiyang channel) to the Bladder (foot taiyang channel) and thence to the Bladder fu, there may be difficult and bloody urination, both indications for this point.

The Pericardium is interiorly-exteriorly coupled with the Sanjiao channel, whilst the interior pathway of the Pericardium primary and divergent channels pass through the middle and lower jiao. Daling P-7 therefore, like many points of the Pericardium channel, is used to harmonise the Stomach and intestines, especially when fire causes the Stomach qi to rebel upwards with symptoms such as foul breath, epigastric pain, vomiting, vomiting of blood, and sudden turmoil disorder.

The Pericardium (hand jueyin) channel and its coupled Liver (foot jueyin) channel are said to 'share the same qi'. This has special significance in relation to the actions of Daling P-7 in clearing heat from the Heart, calming

the spirit and harmonising the Stomach and intestines. Liver qi stagnation may either transform to fire and rise to disturb the Heart and spirit, or transversely invade the Stomach causing Stomach qi to rebel upwards. As a result of the primary focus of Daling P-7 on the upper jiao, its special relationship to the Liver, and the pathway of the Pericardium sinew channel to the anterior ribs, Daling P-7 is also used to unbind the qi of the chest and treat such symptoms as fullness of the chest, shortness of breath, pain of the chest and lateral costal region, sighing and breast pain.

In common with several other points of the channel, Daling P-7 is indicated when febrile disease penetrates to the nutritive and especially the blood levels, agitating the Pericardium and spirit and giving rise to symptoms such as fever with agitation, cracked tongue, insomnia and even mania. This action of Daling P-7 on cooling the blood level further explains its use in the treatment of eczema, wind rash and carbuncles and furuncles. Finally Daling P-7 is the principal point used in the treatment of carpal tunnel syndrome, in which case the needle is inserted obliquely and distally along the carpal tunnel.

COMBINATIONS

- Frequent laughter: Daling P-7, Renzhong DU-26, Lieque LU-7 and Yangxi L.I.-5 (*Great Compendium*).
- Ceaseless laughter: Daling P-7 and Laogong P-8 (*Supplementing Life*).
- Weeping with grief: Daling P-7, Xinshu BL-15, Shenmen HE-7 and Jiexi ST-41 (*Supplementing Life*).
- Pounding sensation below the Heart and propensity to fright: Daling P-7 and Quze P-3 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Oppression of the Heart: Daling P-7 and Laogong P-8 (*Ode of the Jade Dragon*).
- Heart pain: Daling P-7, Ximen P-4 and Quze P-3 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Unbearable Heart pain: Daling P-7 and Shangwan REN-13 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Pain of the Heart and chest: Daling P-7, Neiguan P-6 and Quze P-3 (*Great Compendium*).
- Chest pain: Daling P-7, Yunmen LU-2, Zhongfu LU-1, Yinbai SP-1, Qimen LIV-14, Feishu BL-13 and Hunmen BL-47 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Shortness of breath: Daling P-7 and Chize LU-5 (*Great Compendium*).
- Coughing and dyspnoea: Daling P-7 and Shaoshang LU-11 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Coughing blood: Daling P-7 and Ximen P-4 (*Systematic Classic*).
- Splitting headache with bursting eye pain: Daling P-7 and Touwei ST-8 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Red eyes: Daling P-7 and Muchuang GB-16 (*Supplementing Life*).
- Vomiting clear (watery) saliva: Daling P-7, Shanzhong REN-17, Zhongwan REN-12 and Laogong P-8 (*Great Compendium*).
- Vomiting: Daling P-7, Burong ST-19 and Shangwan REN-13 (*Supplementing Life*).
- Abdominal pain: Daling P-7 and Waiguan SJ-5 (*Song of the Jade Dragon*).
- Abdominal pain and constipation: Daling P-7, Zhigou SJ-6 and Waiguan SJ-5 (*Ode of the Jade Dragon*).
- Obstructed urination: Sanyinjiao SP-6, Yinlingquan SP-9 and Qihai REN-6, followed by Yingu KID-10 and Daling P-7 (*Great Compendium*).

LÁOGONG P-8

Palace of Toil

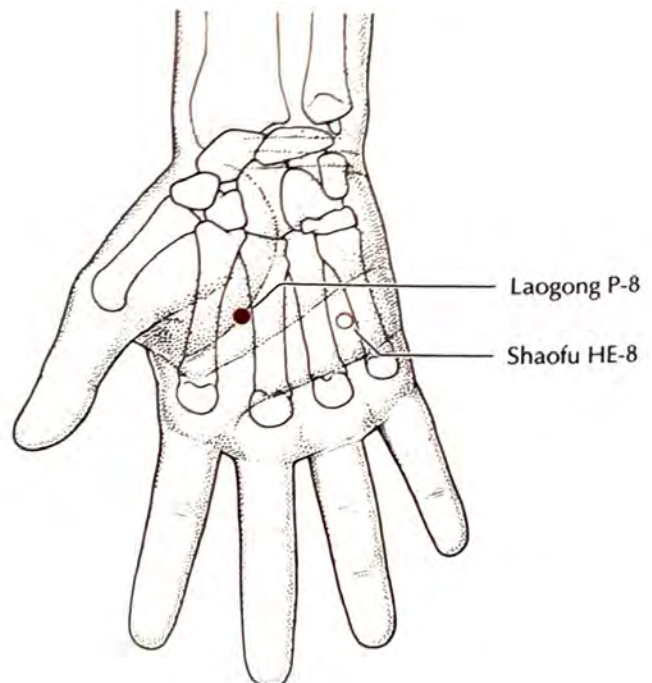
Ying-Spring and Fire point of the
Pericardium channel

Sun Si-miao Ghost point

勞宮

LOCATION

Between the second and third metacarpal bones, proximal to the metacarpo-phalangeal joint, in a depression at the radial side of the third metacarpal bone.



LOCATION NOTE

i. This point may be located at the place where the tip of the middle finger lands when a fist is made; ii. Some classical sources locate this point on the ulnar side of the third metacarpal bone, where the tip of the ring finger lands when a fist is made.

NEEDLING

Perpendicular insertion 0.5 cun.

ACTIONS

Clears heat from the Pericardium and revives consciousness

Clears heat from the Heart and calms the spirit

Harmonises the Stomach and clears heat from the middle jiao

Clears the nutritive level and cools blood

INDICATIONS

- Fever, coma, loss of consciousness, febrile disease accompanied by sweating which continues for days, windstroke, hypertension.
- Epilepsy, mania-depression, fright, sadness, propensity to anger, apprehension, restless zang disorder, ceaseless laughter.
- Heart pain, pain of the chest and lateral costal region, cough.
- Erosion of the mouth and tongue (in children), mouth ulcers, foul breath, difficult ingestion, vomiting, hypogastric (ji ju) masses.
- Vomiting blood, ceaseless nosebleed, blood in the stool, haemorrhoids, dark urine, jaundice, yellow eyes, throat pain.
- Tremor of the hand, eczema and tinea of the hand, scaling of the skin of the hand, heat in the palm of the hand, sweating of the palms, hand painful obstruction.

COMMENTARY

Laogong P-8 is the ying-spring and fire point of the Pericardium channel. According to the *Classic of Difficulties*¹³ ying-spring points are indicated for "heat in the body". Laogong P-8 is a powerful point to revive consciousness and calm the spirit in cases where heat 'collapses' into the Pericardium during the course of febrile diseases, leading to disturbance of the emotions, and in severe cases coma.

There are two major discussions on the relationship of the Heart and the Pericardium channel in the *Spiritual Pivot*. At this early date, it is clear that the Pericardium channel was considered to be the main channel that linked with and treated the Heart itself, and indeed it was said that the Heart channel had no shu points of its own, Laogong P-8 being listed as the ying-spring and fire point of the

Heart channel. It is therefore not only used to clear febrile heat from the Pericardium, the 'wrapping of the Heart', but is one of the principal points to clear Heart fire generated by internal disharmony. Heart fire may result from a number of different factors (see Daling P-7), but due to the close relationship of the Pericardium and Liver jueyin channels, Laogong P-8 is particularly indicated when stagnant Liver fire transmits to the Heart. If Heart fire agitates the spirit there will be various manifestations of psycho-emotional disharmony such as mania-depression, propensity to anger, ceaseless laughter and epilepsy. Like Daling P-7, Laogong P-8 is also able to bolster the spirit and is indicated for such manifestations of deficiency as fright, sadness and apprehension.

If Heart fire condenses body fluids it may generate phlegm, and when this is combined with wind stirred up by Liver yang, the resultant wind-phlegm may give rise to epilepsy or windstroke. The importance of Laogong P-8 in the treatment of epilepsy and also mania-depression is reflected in its inclusion (under its alternative name of Guiku 'Ghost Cave') by Sun Si-miao in his 'thirteen ghost points' for the treatment of these conditions.

The Heart flowers into the tongue and the Spleen opens into the mouth. Mouth and tongue ulcers are differentiated into six main patterns: i. Heart fire, ii. Spleen and Stomach smouldering heat, iii. Kidney and Heart yin deficiency, iv. Spleen qi deficiency complicated with heat, v. blood deficiency with dry heat, and vi. Kidney yang deficiency. Laogong P-8 is indicated for ulceration or erosion of the mouth and tongue from any of these patterns, especially when heat is involved.

The Pericardium primary and divergent channels pass through the diaphragm to the middle and lower jiao and the Pericardium channel is interiorly-exteriorly coupled with the Sanjiao channel. Like many points of the Pericardium channel, therefore, Laogong P-8 also has a strong action on the middle jiao and is indicated in cases where fire disrupts the descent of Stomach qi resulting in foul breath, vomiting and difficult ingestion.

In common with Quze P-3, Daling P-7 and Zhongchong P-9, Laogong P-8 clears heat from the nutritive and blood levels. It may therefore be used when febrile heat at the blood level leads to reckless bleeding disorders such as vomiting blood, nosebleed, blood in the stool etc. Its ability to clear heat from the blood as well as its location, make it suitable for skin disorders affecting the palm such as eczema, tinea and scaling, as well as for heat and abnormal sweating of the palms. It is also indicated for hand painful obstruction and hand tremors.

In qigong practice, Laogong P-8 can be thought of as mirroring Yongquan KID-1 on the soles of the feet. It is also used in practice to 'breathe through' either of these

points, and focusing on and building the qi at Laogong P-8 is a pre-requisite for emitting qi in the treatment of disease by qigong therapy.

Finally Laogong P-8 is cited in the *Song of the Nine Needles for Returning the Yang* for the treatment of collapse of yang characterised by loss of consciousness, aversion to cold, cold counterflow of the limbs, purple lips etc.

COMBINATIONS

- The five types of epilepsy: Laogong P-8 and Yongquan KID-1 (*Miscellaneous Diseases*).
- Incessant laughter: Laogong P-8 and Daling P-7 (*Supplementing Life*).
- Oppression of the Heart: Laogong P-8 and Daling P-7 (*Ode of the Jade Dragon*).
- Incessant nosebleed: Laogong P-8, Kouheliao L.I.-19 and Duiduan DU-27 (*Supplementing Life*).
- Mouth ulcers: Laogong P-8 and Chengjiang REN-24 (*Compilation*).
- Erosion, heat and dryness of the mouth: Laogong P-8, Shaoze SI-1, Sanjian L.I.-3 and Taichong LIV-3 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Throat pain: Laogong P-8, Fengfu DU-16 and Tianchuang SI-16 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Difficult ingestion: Laogong P-8, Yanggang BL-48, Qimen LIV-14 and Shaoshang LU-11 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Vomiting: Laogong P-8 and Shaoshang LU-11 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).

ZHONGCHONG P-9

Middle Rushing

Jing-Well and Wood point of the Pericardium channel

中冲

LOCATION

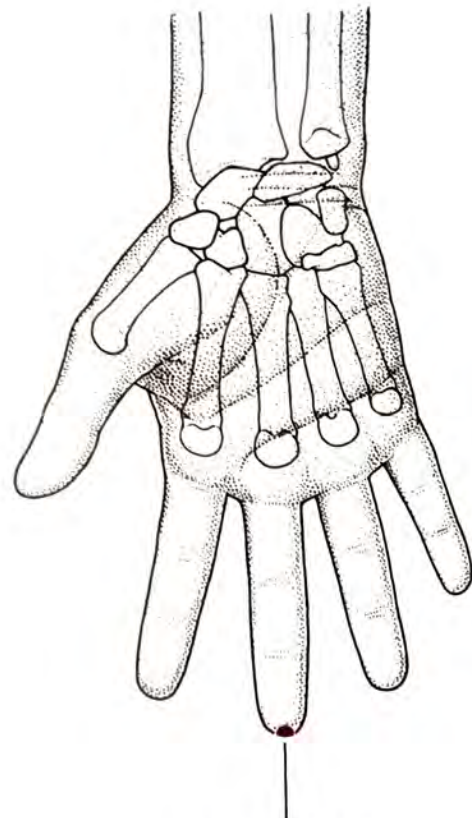
In the centre of the tip of the middle finger. Alternatively, this point is sometimes located at the radial side of the middle finger, at the junction of lines drawn along the radial border of the nail and the base of the nail, approximately 0.1 cun from the corner of the nail.

NEEDLING

Perpendicular or oblique insertion directed proximally 0.1 to 0.2 cun, or prick to bleed.

ACTIONS

Clears heat from the Pericardium and revives consciousness
Clears the Heart and benefits the tongue
Clears summer-heat



Zhongchong P-9

INDICATIONS

- Windstroke, injury by summer-heat, loss of consciousness, fever, fever with agitation and oppression, heat in the body like fire, headache, hypertension.
- Pain at the root of the tongue, stiffness of the tongue, inability to speak, night-time crying in children.
- Heart pain, agitation of the Heart, oppression of the Heart with absence of sweating, heat of the palms, tinnitus.
- Vomiting and diarrhoea, epigastric pain, sudden turmoil disorder, childhood nutritional impairment.

COMMENTARY

Zhongchong P-9 is the jing-well point of the Pericardium channel, and in common with many of the jing-well points (the terminal and most dynamic point of the channel) has a powerful effect to restore consciousness. There are some particular differences, however, that distinguish Zhongchong P-9 from the other jing-well points. Firstly, located on the middle finger, this is the most distal of all the jing-well points and the only one located in the centre rather than at the corner of the nail. Secondly, as a point of the Pericardium channel, Zhongchong P-9 is especially suitable for restoring

consciousness, which occurs when the spirit is dislodged from the Heart.

Loss of consciousness with stiffness of the tongue may occur during the course of febrile diseases when pathogenic heat, complicated with phlegm, collapses into the Pericardium. The affinity of Zhongchong P-9 for the tongue, reflected in such classical indications as pain at the root of the tongue, stiffness of the tongue and inability to speak, underlines the intimate relationship that was held to exist between the Pericardium and the Heart, since it is the Heart which flows into the tongue and the Heart (luo-connecting) channel rather than the Pericardium channel that travels to the root of the tongue.

Like several points of the Pericardium channel, Zhongchong P-9 also treats injury by summer-heat characterised by fever, agitation, vomiting, diarrhoea and collapse.

The Pericardium primary and divergent channels traverse all three jiao and the Pericardium is interiorly-exteriorly coupled with the Sanjiao channel. Like many points of the Pericardium channel, therefore, Zhongchong P-9 also has a strong action on the middle jiao and is indicated for vomiting and diarrhoea, epigastric pain and sudden turmoil disorder. In the treatment of paediatric disorders, it may be used for night-time crying in children and childhood nutritional impairment. Among other patterns, the former may be due to accumulated heat in the Heart and the latter to heat and blockage in the middle jiao.

COMBINATIONS

- Loss of consciousness from windstroke: Zhongchong P-9, Renzhong DU-26 and Hegu L.I.-4. If this is ineffective, needle Yamen DU-15 and Dadun LIV-1 (*Great Compendium*).
- Swelling and pain below the tongue: Zhongchong P-9 and Lianquan REN-23 (*One Hundred Symptoms*).
- Stiffness of the tongue: Zhongchong P-9, Shaoshang LU-11, Yuji LU-10, Yamen DU-15, Erjian L.I.-2, Yingu KID-10 and Rangu KID-2 (*Great Compendium*).
- Heart pain with fullness and agitation and stiff tongue: Zhongchong P-9 and Yinxi HE-6 (*Supplementing Life*).
- Pain of the Heart with shortness of breath: Zhongchong P-9, Qimen LIV-14, Changqiang DU-1, Tiantu REN-22 and Xiabai LU-4 (*Thousand Ducat Formulas*).
- Heat in the body like fire and splitting headache: Zhongchong P-9 and Mingmen DU-4 (*Supplementing Life*).

NOTES

- 1 *Spiritual Pivot* Chapter 71.
- 2 *Classic of Difficulties* 68th Difficulty.
- 3 *Spiritual Pivot* Chapter 44.
- 4 *Spiritual Pivot* Chapter 78.
- 5 *Spiritual Pivot* Chapter 66.
- 6 *A Spot of Snow on a Red Hot Store* (Hong Lu Dian Xue) by Gong Ju-zhong 1630.
- 7 *Essential Questions* Chapter 33.
- 8 *Spiritual Pivot* Chapter 44.
- 9 *Classic of Difficulties* 29th Difficulty.
- 10 *Classic of Difficulties* 69th Difficulty.
- 11 *Spiritual Pivot* Chapter 8.
- 12 *Essential Questions* Chapter 62.
- 13 *Classic of Difficulties* 68th Difficulty.